

Next you will need to load the Chrome OS Virtual Disk Image within VirtualBox. This can be done by choosing - Use an existing virtual drive file - option selecting the Virtual Disk Image that you extracted earlier. The next most important step before you're ready to launch Chrome OS within a virtual machine is to configure its network adaptor settings, otherwise you won't be able to access the internet.

Within the VirtualBox application you need to right click on the loaded Chrome OS image and select the Settings option or press Ctrl+S. This will present a new menu window where you have to select the Network option in the left panel and select the Advanced option. Now you can set the Adaptor Type, which in this case would be Intel PRO/1000 MT Desktop (82540M). If you know the exact adaptor type on your machine and find it in the drop down list then select that but the Intel PRO/1000 should be generic enough for most machines. Click OK and save the changes.

Now you are ready to launch the virtual machine with Chrome OS. In the main VirtualBox screen double left click on the Chrome OS image. The operating system will begin booting in the virtual machine but you may find that the mouse is not responding. This can be quickly fixed by selecting - Disable Mouse Integration - from the Machine menu at the top of the screen or by pressing the Ctrl+I. Once your mouse is active you're ready to take Chrome OS for a virtual test drive without having to worry about any conflicts with your default operating system.

Running from Bootable Removable Device

Typically an operating system is tested using a bootable USB such as with Ubuntu, but needs to be installed onto a machine's hard disk for maximum functionality. However, with Chromium this is not necessarily true. Since the maximum functionality of Chromium is via the internet and you can opt to have all your data and applications synced to your Google Account, the need for a hard installation isn't paramount. In such a case having a Chrome OS bootable USB or SD Card allows you to plug in to any networked machine and start your operating system directly. But if you wish to use the extended storage of your machine for data storage offline it is advisable to proceed with a complete dual boot. In both cases, the first step is to create a bootable USB or SD Card.

The first step in this process is to download the Chrome build of your choice. We are using Hexxeh's Vanilla Chrome build 4028. The downloadable file is a compressed Zip that needs to be unzipped using 7-Zip File